WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

UKRAINE

Europe

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Kyiv	Capital and main business centre; seat of the government, the National Bank of Ukraine, UkraineInvest and most international firms and lenders	Finance, IT and defence technology, professional services, reconstruction
Lviv and western Ukraine	Gateway to Poland and the EU, further from the front line and a base for businesses relocating west since 2022	Manufacturing, IT, logistics, light industry
Odesa and the Black Sea ports	Ukraine's main maritime outlet for grain, metals and other exports, operating under wartime security arrangements	Port logistics, agri-exports, storage, shipping services
Zakarpattia and the western border crossings	Road and rail crossings into Hungary, Slovakia and Romania, important for EU-bound freight	Cross-border logistics, warehousing, assembly
Dnipro	Large industrial and engineering city in the east-centre, with metals, machine-building and aerospace traditions	Engineering, metals, defence production, energy equipment
Central agricultural belt (Vinnytsia, Poltava, Cherkasy)	Core of Ukraine's grain and oilseed production and processing	Agriculture, food processing, agri-inputs, bioenergy
Kharkiv	Second-largest city and a major industrial and university centre close to the front line	Defence technology, engineering, rebuilding of housing and utilities

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- UkraineInvest, the national investment promotion office, supports foreign investors with market entry, project matching and government liaison
- Law on state support for significant investments: projects of at least €20 million creating at least 80 jobs can sign a special investment agreement giving support worth up to 30% of the investment, including import-duty exemption on new equipment, land and infrastructure
- Industrial parks with state co-financing for infrastructure, and the Diia City regime for IT companies, which may pay a 9% tax on distributed profits instead of the standard 18% corporate income tax
- War-risk and political-risk cover from MIGA (which has issued $948 million since February 2022), the US DFC, the Export Credit Agency of Ukraine and private insurers
- The US–Ukraine Reconstruction Investment Fund, which approved its first investment in March 2026 and has assembled an initial eight-project portfolio worth $1.2 billion

- Co-investment with the EBRD, IFC, EIB and the World Bank, and EU programmes funded under the €90 billion Ukraine Support Loan and the Ukraine Facility
- EU candidate route: accession negotiations, with the first cluster opened in June 2026, are steadily aligning Ukrainian law with the EU single market

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Ukraine in November 2026 is a wartime economy with deep international backing and one of the largest reconstruction pipelines in the world. Real GDP grew 1.8% in 2025, and the IMF approved a new $8.1 billion, 48-month Extended Fund Facility in February 2026, completing its first review in July with $2.2 billion disbursed so far. International reserves rose to $49.1 billion at the end of October 2026, helped by $3.3 billion of EU support that month, and the EU's €90 billion Ukraine Support Loan covers 2026–27, with the Commission proposing the remaining €45 billion for 2027 on 30 October. Foreign direct investment continues despite the war, at $640 million in the first quarter of 2026 and $487 million in the second. EU accession talks formally opened their first cluster on 15 June 2026, and the World Bank Group used the Ukraine Recovery Conference in Gdańsk in June to launch new risk-sharing and co-financing platforms for private investors.

Ukraine's defining challenge is the continuing Russian invasion, which drives security, energy and financing conditions. Martial law has been renewed by parliament in 90-day periods, most recently for the 20th time, and attacks on energy infrastructure led the National Bank to forecast a 0.4% fall in GDP in 2026 and to raise its key rate to 16.5% in October, with inflation at 10% in September. Public debt reached 98.4% of GDP at the end of 2025, and the draft 2027 budget allocates about two-thirds of spending to security and defence. Mitigation is substantial: concessional EU, IMF and World Bank finance, a growing market for war-risk insurance, and US-brokered talks, including a local ceasefire around Oleshky from late October and technical meetings planned for November. For investors able to manage the risk, early positioning in energy, logistics, agri-processing, defence technology and reconstruction offers a strong first-mover advantage.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
War and martial law	Martial law and general mobilisation remain in force and are renewed by parliament every 90 days; missile and drone strikes affect assets, staff and logistics	Locate assets in western and central regions where possible, use hardened sites and back-up power, and build security and continuity plans
Physical and political risk cover	Commercial insurance for war damage remains limited and costly	Use MIGA, DFC and Export Credit Agency of Ukraine cover, the new URIF political-risk framework and private war-damage policies of up to $50 million
Energy supply	Attacks on generation and grids cause outages and raise costs; the National Bank expects shelling alone to add about 0.7 points to inflation	Invest in on-site generation and storage; the World Bank has identified about $26 billion of priority energy investments, a major opportunity
Inflation and interest rates	Inflation reached 10% in September 2026 and the key rate rose to 16.5% in October, raising the cost of hryvnia finance	Use DFI and donor-backed finance in foreign currency; the National Bank targets a return to 5% inflation in 2028
Public finances	Public debt reached 98.4% of GDP at end-2025 and the 2027 draft budget has a deficit of nearly UAH 1.7 trillion	The IMF programme and the €90 billion EU loan provide multi-year financing and a reform anchor
Currency controls	Wartime foreign-exchange rules still restrict some capital movements and dividend repatriation	Take local advice on current National Bank rules, which are being eased gradually, and structure finance through DFIs where possible
Governance and EU alignment	Rule of law and anti-corruption reforms remain under close EU and IMF scrutiny, and Hungary has delayed further accession clusters	Reform conditions in EU and IMF funding strengthen transparency; use international arbitration clauses and DFI co-investment

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Ukraine is a market at war, and investors should be clear about what that means: martial law and mobilisation remain in force, strikes on energy and other infrastructure continue, and the National Bank expects GDP to fall 0.4% in 2026 before recovering. Against this, the country's financing position is underpinned by an $8.1 billion IMF programme, the €90 billion EU Ukraine Support Loan for 2026–27 and reserves of $49.1 billion, and Ukraine has opened EU accession negotiations. Diplomacy is active, with a local ceasefire in Oleshky agreed in October and US-brokered technical talks planned for November 2026, but a comprehensive settlement has not been reached and Russia continues to demand territory Ukraine rejects ceding. Investors should combine political and war-risk insurance, DFI partnership and robust security planning; sanctions on Russia also apply to any counterparties with Russian links, so screening is essential. With these measures, Ukraine offers access to a large, EU-aligned reconstruction market at an early stage.

MARKET ACCESS

Ukraine trades with the EU under its Association Agreement and Deep and Comprehensive Free Trade Area, and is a WTO member with free trade agreements with partners including the UK, Canada and Turkey. EU accession negotiations opened their first cluster in June 2026, and continuing alignment with EU rules is bringing Ukrainian standards closer to the single market. Exports of grain, oilseeds, metals and iron ore move through the Odesa-region Black Sea ports, the Danube ports and road and rail crossings into Poland, Slovakia, Hungary and Romania, while neighbouring Moldova is a useful partner for logistics and the Ukraine reconstruction supply chain. The main export markets are the EU, Asia and the Middle East, with agri-food the largest export category.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President and Cabinet of Ministers (Prime Minister Yuliia Svyrydenko)	Set wartime economic policy, reconstruction priorities and EU accession strategy	Primary reference point for strategic direction and flagship projects
UkraineInvest	National investment promotion office supporting foreign investors and administering investor support	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentives
National Bank of Ukraine	Sets the key rate (16.5% since October 2026), manages $49.1 billion of reserves and the wartime currency regime	Key counterpart on currency controls, repatriation and banking
Ministry of Economy and Environment	Oversees investment policy, industrial parks, state support for significant investments and the Reconstruction Investment Fund	Relevant for incentives, industrial parks and reconstruction projects
Ministry of Finance	Manages the budget, public debt and relations with the IMF, EU and other lenders	Counterpart on tax policy and donor-funded programmes
US–Ukraine Reconstruction Investment Fund (URIF)	Joint fund with the US DFC investing in energy, logistics, critical minerals and technology, with an initial $1.2 billion project portfolio	Co-investment route for strategic projects with political-risk cover
Naftogaz and Ukrenergo	State energy companies responsible for gas production and transmission, and for the national power grid	Essential partners for energy security, generation and storage projects

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The American Chamber of Commerce in Ukraine, the European Business Association, the British Ukrainian Chamber of Commerce and the Ukrainian Chamber of Commerce and Industry are the main business associations, with active dialogue with government on wartime regulation and reconstruction. The annual Ukraine Recovery Conference, held in Gdańsk in June 2026, is the main forum for governments, lenders and investors. The EBRD, IFC, MIGA, the World Bank, the EIB and the US DFC are the leading development finance partners, and the World

Bank's new co-financing platform aims to mobilise up to $6 billion. UkraineInvest and embassy commercial sections arrange investor introductions and site visits.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Ukraine suits investors with a long horizon and a tolerance for managed risk: energy investors in distributed generation, storage, wind and grid projects; agri-food and processing companies; logistics operators serving western border routes and the Black Sea ports; defence and dual-use technology firms; construction-materials and engineering suppliers for reconstruction; and IT companies using the Diia City regime. Projects structured with DFI partners and war-risk cover are best placed, and investors should screen counterparties for links to sanctioned Russian entities.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage UkraineInvest and test eligibility for support
Discuss the project and check whether it qualifies for a significant-investment agreement, industrial-park incentives or the Diia City regime.

STEP 2: Secure war-risk and political-risk cover
Approach MIGA, the US DFC, the Export Credit Agency of Ukraine and private insurers early, as cover shapes structure and financing.

STEP 3: Partner with development finance institutions
Seek co-investment from the EBRD, IFC, EIB or the Reconstruction Investment Fund to share risk and strengthen project governance.

STEP 4: Plan for security, energy and continuity
Select sites carefully, build in back-up power and shelters, and prepare staff and supply-chain contingency plans under martial law.

STEP 5: Monitor talks, currency rules and EU accession
Track peace negotiations, National Bank currency liberalisation and progress on EU accession clusters, which will shape timing and returns.